

Acne Classification and Management Overview

Clinical Presentation of Acne

- (bii) Acute papulopustular acne with small nodules (<0.5–1.0 cm).
- (c) Severe papulopustular acne progressing to conglobate acne, characterized by sinus tract formation and deep scarring.
- (d) Conglobate acne affecting the trunk.

Treatment Follow-Up and Response Evaluation

Regular follow-up for individual acne treatments is essential to assess therapeutic efficacy in relation to the degree of inflammation and scarring potential. In more complex cases, treatment response may be delayed. Patients should be advised to seek earlier medical review if they experience adverse effects or poor tolerability.

In cases of treatment failure, the dermatologist should investigate potential causes. The current guidelines provide practical checklists (referenced in Tables 2–4) outlining common reasons for lack of response and recommended next steps.

Treatment Algorithms

- **Figure 2:** Treatment algorithm for predominant comedonal facial acne.
Dose adjustments based on adverse events (e.g., irritation). See text for details.
- **Figure 3:** Treatment algorithm for predominant papulopustular facial acne.
Dose adjustments based on adverse events.
†Second-generation antibiotics.
‡Combination therapies: clindamycin 1%/tretinoin 0.025% (avoid with oral antibiotics), adapalene 0.1%/BPO 2.5%, clindamycin 1%/BPO 5% (avoid

with oral antibiotics).

§For female patients: prefer contraceptive pills containing anti-androgenic progestins. See text for details.

- **Figure 4:** Treatment algorithm for nodular and/or conglobate acne.

Dose adjustments based on adverse events.

†Combination topical therapies as above (avoid with oral antibiotics).

‡Anti-androgenic oral contraceptives preferred in females.

§Oral isotretinoin typically administered for 16–24 weeks. See text for details.

Global Evaluation Acne (GEA) Scale for Facial Acne

Grade	Severity	Description
0	Clear	No lesions; residual pigmentation or erythema may be present
1	Almost clear	Very few scattered comedones and minimal papules
2	Mild	Less than half the face involved; few comedones, papules, and pustules
3	Moderate	More than half the face involved; numerous comedones, papules, and pustules; possibly one nodule
4	Severe	Entire face involved; widespread papules, pustules, comedones; rare nodules
5	Very severe	Extensive inflammatory lesions with nodules covering the face

General Skin Care Recommendations

All acne patients should incorporate the following into their daily skin care routine:

- Use of broad-spectrum **anti-UVA and UVB** sunscreen
- Gentle **cleansers with a skin-friendly pH**
- **Non-comedogenic moisturizers**

These measures support overall acne management and help maintain skin barrier integrity.